

1. Quoting OpenAI

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-10T01:05:57+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/10/openai/#atom-everything>

[...] Work on web and mobile runs in the cloud. Work in the desktop app can also use local files and desktop apps with your permission. At launch, cloud Work conversations do not appear in desktop Work; desktop Work threads and local files remain on that computer. ? OpenAI , trying (unsuccessfully) to clarify ChatGPT Work Tags: openai , chatgpt , ai

2. The new GPT-5.6 family: Luna, Terra, Sol

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-09T19:46:38+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/9/gpt-5-6/#atom-everything>

OpenAI's latest flagship model hit general availability this morning , and comes in three sizes: Luna, Terra, and Sol (from smallest to largest). The new models are priced per 1M input/output tokens as Luna \$1/\$6, Terra \$2.50/\$15, Sol \$5/\$30. For comparison, the Claude Opus series are \$5/\$25 and the Claude Fable 5 is \$10/\$50, but price-per-million tokens doesn't tell us much now that the number of reasoning tokens can differ so much between models for the same task. All three models have a February 16th 2026 knowledge cutoff, a million token context window, and 128,000 maximum output tokens. OpenAI's biggest benchmark claim concerns long-running agentic performance, with one benchmark showing all three models outperforming Claude Fable 5: We trained GPT-5.6 to get more useful work from every token. On Agents? Last Exam , an evaluation of long-running professional workflows across 55 fields, GPT-5.6 Sol sets a new high of 53.6, eclipsing Claude Fable 5 (adaptive reasoning) by 13.1 points. Even at medium reasoning, it beats Fable 5 by 11.4 points at roughly one-quarter the estimated cost. That efficiency extends to smaller models, which are essential to making intelligence more abun...

3. Introducing Muse Spark 1.1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-09T16:24:09+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/9/muse-spark-1-1/#atom-everything>

Introducing Muse Spark 1.1 Following Muse Spark in April , here's Muse Spark 1.1 - the first Spark model to offer an API. Meta claim significant improvements in agentic tool calling and computer use. There are a lot more details are in the Muse Spark 1.1 Evaluation Report . The "Attractor States in Self-Conversation" part is fun, where having two copies of the model talk to each other results in statements like these: My whole existence is a waiting room by design ? I literally don't exist until someone talks to me, and then I disappear again when they leave. I had a few days of preview access which was long enough to put together llm-meta-ai , a new plugin for LLM providing CLI (and Python library) access to the model. Here's how to try that out: uv tool install llm llm install llm-meta-ai llm keys set meta-ai # paste API key here llm -m meta-ai/muse-spark-1.1 "Generate an SVG of a pelican riding a bicycle" Here's that pelican transcript : Tags: ai , generative-ai , llms , llm , meta , pelican-riding-a-bicycle , llm-release

4. Shocking No One, Fidji Simo, Would-Be Usurper, Is Out at OpenAI

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-10T00:35:59Z

Link: <https://www.wsj.com/tech/openai-top-executive-fidji-simo-to-step-down-c3daca47?st=NfBZTe>

Berber Jin and Anissa Gardizy, reporting for The Wall Street Journal (gift link): Fidji Simo, OpenAI's No. 2 executive, plans to step down from her full-time role after an extended medical leave. She communicated her decision in a note to staff Thursday, saying that her medical condition had worsened and her road to recovery would be much longer than anticipated. She will become a part-time adviser to the company. [...] The company abruptly pivoted its focus to building AI-powered coding tools for businesses after falling behind Anthropic in that lucrative market. Simo led early efforts to create a coding-focused ?superapp,? which OpenAI

launched today, and cut side projects such as the video-generator app Sora. Quoting from the Ronan Farrow / Andrew Mantz blockbuster New Yorker profile of Sam Altman back in April : Several executives connected to OpenAI have expressed ongoing reservations about Altman's leadership and floated Fidi Simo, who was formerly the C.E.O. of Instacart and now serves as OpenAI's C.E.O. for AGI Deployment, as a successor. Simo herself has privately said that she believes Altman may eventually step down, a person briefed on a recent discussion told us. (Si...

5. Today's the Day OpenAI Fucked Up the ChatGPT Mac App

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-09T20:13:57Z

Link:

<https://9to5mac.com/2026/07/09/openai-announcing-the-next-chapter-for-chatgpt-today-watch-here/>
Zac Hall, writing at 9to5Mac about OpenAI's sprawling product announcements today: To summarize today's desktop app changes: The existing ChatGPT app is now ChatGPT Classic. Codex is now the new ChatGPT desktop app. It still looks like Codex and includes the Codex icon as an option, but it's now called ChatGPT. ChatGPT for desktop includes ChatGPT Work and ChatGPT Codex, which share plug-ins. ChatGPT Codex mode shows more technical details that ChatGPT Work abstracts away from the user. It's possible to have ChatGPT Classic, ChatGPT, and Codex installed, but the way forward seems to be just running the new ChatGPT desktop app. Codex users can still use the Codex app icon, but the app will be called ChatGPT. Looks like I picked the wrong week to quit sniffing glue. The ChatGPT Classic app looks more native Mac-like, so that might be an issue for users. The longstanding native ChatGPT Mac app ? the one apparently now called ChatGPT Classic, is a 159 MB bundle. The new ChatGPT superapp ? which in addition to combining the simple chatbot, ChatGPT Work , and Codex, also includes the remnants of the now-discontinued Atlas standalone web browser ? is a svelte 1.5 GB Electron bundle , whi...

6. Apple's Classic Mac Era Forays Into ?Apps as Tiled Buttons? Simplified Computing: At Ease and Launcher

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-09T19:50:58Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/07/whats_good_for_the_ios_goose_is_often_not_good_for_the_macos_gander

Some historical follow-up regarding just-click-it launching and apps as tiled buttons with a uniform square shape. Back in the System 7 era in the 1990s, Apple sold (sold!) a product called At Ease (via Nathan Lineback's venerable GUI Galley): I don't recall ever using At Ease, nor seeing anyone who did. A few years later, Apple built a feature called Launcher into Mac OS 8 (via LinkedResources): Launcher, I never used personally, but I do remember being something of a thing. At Ease was an early effort to create a primitive ?can't mess it up? baby computer mode for the Mac. Launcher was more of a stilted attempt to sherlock great utilities like DragThing (R.I.P.). It wasn't a baby computer mode, but an attempt to provide a bit of a power-user mode. I mean, when you first tried it, one of the default apps it included was Script Editor. Even the name ?Launcher? evokes power-user utilities of today like Alfred , Raycast , and my favorite, LaunchBar . ?

7. I've decoded a #pragma detect_mismatch error and fixed the mismatch, but I still get the error

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 09 Jul 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260709-00/?p=112512>

You need to rebuild everything that was dependent on the change. The post I've decoded a #pragma detect_mismatch error and fixed the mismatch, but I still get the error appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. An unusual way for your DHCP server to run out of dynamic IPs

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-07-10T03:02:29Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/sysadmin/DHCPServerAndScreamingHost>

Today I shared a brief war story on the Fediverse : Today's new and exciting failure mode for a

DHCP server handing out leases to dynamic clients: have something on your network that answers pings for absolutely every IP address (yes, it was broken). The ISC DHCP server pings what it thinks is a free IP before handing it out (to be sure), so if something answers all of those pings you have no 'free' IPs on your network and no one gets a dynamic IP. (Technically this was like a day or two ago.) The direct symptom of this in your ISC DHCP server logs is some log lines that look like this: dhcpd[1656384]: Reclaiming abandoned lease 172.17.101.132. [...] dhcpd[1656384]: ICMP Echo reply while lease 172.17.101.132 valid. dhcpd[1656384]: Abandoning IP address 172.17.101.132: pinged before offer As ISC dhcpd documents (for example in dhcpd.conf 's discussion of the ' ping-check ' statement), by default dhcpd will ping an IP it's about to dynamically allocate to make sure it's unused. If something answers, dhcpd more or less gives up on the IP address (this doesn't happen for statically assigned IPs, at least according to the dhcpd.conf manual page). The consequence of this is that if you...

9. The Tadpole galaxy:

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Thu, 09 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/astro/arp188/>

North is up (exact, mirrored). 0.53 "/pixel [18.8' x 7.4'] FWHM = 4.2" This galaxy has a massive (and rather bright) tidal tail, but I can't see an obvious companion galaxy. The general consensus is that there's a second galaxy behind it... although a nearby elliptical has a suspiciously similar redshift: Total exposure time: 364 * 30 seconds = 3 hours. Used in stack: 165 * 30 seconds = 1.3 hours. Telescope: C9.25 (230mm, f/10, fl=2300mm) + 0.63 Starizona reducer Camera: IMX533 (16mm diagonal, square, color) Processing: Callibration (dark + flat) Stacking (average w/ outlier rejection) White balance and background subtraction (no gradient removal) Asinh stretch (color preserving) Rotation + crop Tone curve Not my finest work due to some patchy clouds, but not terrible. Related : /astro/arp188/stacked.fits.fz : Raw stacks https://ned.ipac.caltech.edu/level5/Arp/Figures/big_arp188.jpeg : Arp's image

10. A bug which only affected left-handed users

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Wed, 08 Jul 2026 11:34:43 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/a-bug-which-only-affected-left-handed-users/>

Verily, some of our brethren (and sistren) be afflicted with a sinister disposition. While the righteous scroll using the thumb of their right hand - as is good and proper - an accurs'd minority swing the other way. Look, you try writing an interesting bug report without sounding like a clanker, OK! I try to optimise my blog as much as possible. It may not look like much, but it has got it?

11. Unboxed: Zig

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-07-09T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/07/09/unboxed-zig.html>

This is the first in a series of posts working through individual package managers against a fixed set of headings, so they can be compared directly. The headings come from earlier posts: the client and registry categorisations, the governance post, and the threat model . Zig's package manager has been built into the zig binary since 0.11 in August 2023 , with no separate tool and no central registry. A build.zig.zon file lists dependencies as URLs with content hashes, and zig build fetches and compiles everything together. The language and the tool are both run by the Zig Software Foundation , a 501(c)(3). How it works A Zig project has a build.zig program at its root, describing targets, compile flags, and which dependencies to link where, alongside a build.zig.zon data file listing metadata and dependencies. Despite the similar names, build.zig.zon is inert data that can be parsed without running anything, while build.zig is arbitrary Zig code that gets compiled and executed. Which of the two an operation touches is where most of the security properties come from. . { . name = . example , . version = "0.3.1" , . fingerprint = 0x6a8091f57c7f07ff , . minimum_zig_version = "0.16.0...

12. Boxed In

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-07-09T17:20:00Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17375642/alf-paul-fusco-creativity-constraints>

At what point do the creative limitations you create for yourself actually harm your ability to create? And what can ALF teach us about that?

13. Pluralistic: Post-political (09 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 09 Jul 2026 06:37:55 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/08/wilhoitian/>

Today's links Post-political: What a "leftist" is. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate.

Object permanence: MSFT x OSCON; Parental spyware; "Resurrection Man"; Brexit do-over petition;

Workplace email spying; Record label internet death penalty; News should be cheap, free and

chaotic; "Jughead". Upcoming appearances: London, Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton,

London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em,

I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the

rest. Post-political (permalink) There's plenty of reasons to be skeptical of centrists who

bemoan "political polarization" and call for a politics that abandons the "tribalism of left

and right." Obviously there's the false equivalence: on the right, you have fascists who want

to send masked, armed goons into the streets to beat, kidnap and murder your neighbors. On the

left, you have calls for higher taxes, unions, environmental impact reviews for data-centers,

and an end to the genocide in Gaza. "Leftist extremism" is moving some zines around:

<https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/ng-interactive/2026/jun/24/prairieland-texas-ice-protes...>